SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Course Descriptions

Contract All Courses |

First-Year Seminar

FY 1000 - Ethics of Engagement

Credits: 4

This course introduces students to academic and campus life at Old Westbury, emphasizing the themes of self-discovery, the meaning of a liberal education, the relationship of the individual to society and the nature of values and of personal and social responsibility. By situating the major intellectual and emotional challenges students confront in their first year of college within the framework of ethics, the course encourages students to evaluate their ideas and assumptions, and the impact of their decisions on themselves, their community and the world. Organized around a series of ever-widening concentric circles, the course moves from a discussion of the role of ethics in individual life, to ethics in personal relationships, to ethics in the Old Westbury community and culminates in the quest for social justice and sustainability in the American and global context. In the process, students are challenged to consider multiple perspectives and to reflect upon their identities, values and aspirations within the larger common good. The course fosters critical thinking and the effective articulation of ideas by introducing students to the close reading of texts and the writing of substantive analytical essays that are the basis of most college learning. Students will also be expected to write weekly reflective journals and to produce a final project. FY 1000 is “linked” to a Liberal Education Curriculum course in a Learning Community.

FY 3000 - Undergraduate Teaching Assistant Seminar

Credits: 4

This course trains students to be effective teaching assistants. Teaching assistants will regularly attend an assigned section of a First-Year Seminar course and work closely with the instructor of the course. Teaching assistants will also be required to attend a one-hour a week seminar with either the Director or Assistant Director of the First-Year Experience.

Prerequisites

"B" average; upper-division standing; permission of the First-Year Experience Program

FY 4000 - Advanced Undergraduate Teaching Assistant Seminar

Credits: 4

This course allows students who have taken FY 3000
to work more closely with students. They are able to provide mentoring, advising assistance as well as sharing their prior experience from the FY 3000
students. Teaching assistants are required to meet with either the Director of Assistant Director of the First-Year Experience for a one-hour a week seminar.

Prerequisites

FY 3000
and permission of the First-Year Experience Program

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